

Gabriel Dirksen

Current GIS research assistant and MGIS candidate

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EXPERIENCE

Calvin University, Grand Rapids, MI — GIS Research Assistant

January 2025 - PRESENT

Built and maintained an entirely new web mapping application utilizing Esri's Experience Builder software

Created widgets and widget actions for a specific and streamlined user interface

Designed aesthetics, function, and flow of the mapping website

Calvin University, Grand Rapids, MI — McGregor Research Fellow

May 2024 - August 2024

Worked directly with professors to highlight failings within the MDOC reintegration process along with ways to curb recidivism rates

Created a new mathematical index to highlight Michigan cities capabilities to accommodate returning citizens

Produced a final report for presentation and first-authored a research paper for journal publication utilizing the findings from said research

Returning Citizen Services, Grand Rapids, MI — Quality Assurance Intern

May 2023 - November 2024

Conducted quality assurance on a master file within a large Excel spreadsheet database, ensuring data accuracy across 3,500+ records.

Identified and corrected inconsistencies in data entries, reducing errors by 20% through rigorous validation processes.

Collaborated with data management team to document findings and implement process improvements, enhancing database reliability.

EDUCATION

Calvin University, Grand Rapids, MI — Politics, Philosophy, Economics, BA

September 2021 - May 2025

Deans Scholarship, 3.6 GPA

SKILLS

ArcGIS Online Catalogue

Microsoft Excel

Quality Assurance

Research

Writing

AWARDS

McGregor Fellowship Award -
For academic excellence and research opportunities

2025 AAG Detroit Convention Paper Presenter

GIS Certificate

VOLUNTEER WORK

Maryhouse Volunteer - helping women and children remain fed and housed

Interfaith Rotating Winter Shelter Volunteer

EXTRA CURRICULARS

NCAA Collegiate Men's Basketball Player, 3 years

Student Planning Committee member for PolsEcon Department

Teaching Assistant - Intro to GIS Course (Geo360)

Calvin University, Grand Rapids, MI — *Geographic Information Systems, MS*

Starting September 2025

Currently enrolled in Calvin's online MGIS program, with the goal to graduate with a masters degree in one year.